STOMA CARE CLINIC

DIETRY ADVICE FOR THOSE WITH A COLOSTOMY

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It is important to eat a varied well balcanced diet to remain healthy; being too restrictive with what you eat may lead to malnutirition and boredom.

For the first two weeks it is advised to follow a low fibre diet, i.e. avoid or eat in moderation fruit, vegetables and wholegrain products.

After the initial two weeks it is very important that you follow a normal diet.

Increase your fibre intake; try products which are made from wholemeal flour.

Select a greater variety of fruit and vegetables. It may be necessary to peel them.

Eat regularly. Do not try to alter the activity of the stoma by reducing fluid intake or missing meals. This will either make you dehydrated or make your stoma work more.

Introduce new foods one at a time so that you can identify those which may cause a problem.

Chew the food well, to prevent air entering your system and causing flatus.

Try to keep to your ideal weight.

Be sure to drink ample fluids. (If you have kidney or heart problems the doctor may have restricted your fluid intake, therefore stick to that advice.)

Food that my increase odour are: asparagus, broccoli, Brussels' sprouts, cabbage, cauliflower, eggs, fish, garlic, onions, some spices.

Food and beverages that may increase gas are: beans, beer, broccoli, Brussels' sprouts, cabbage, carbonated beverages, cauliflower, corn, cucumber, mushrooms, peas and spinach.

Food and beverages that may thicken your stools are: applesauce, bananas, buttermilk, cheese, marshmallows, noodles, rice, toast and yoghurt.

Food and beverages that may cause loose stools: beer or alcohol, broccoli, prunes, prune juice and spinach.

However your own personal experience of food is what matters and you may find that you never have any problems.

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